

5 And the glory of the LORD shall be revealed; and all flesh shall see it together; for the mouth of the LORD hath spoken it.

6 ¶ A voice saith, Proclaim; and he saith, What shall I proclaim? All flesh is grass, and all its goodness is as the flower of the field:

7 The grass withereth, the flower fadeth; because the breath of the LORD hath blown upon it; surely the people is grass.

8 The grass withereth, the flower fadeth; but the word of our God will stand firm for ever.

9 ¶ Upon a high mountain get thee up, thou that bringest good tidings to Zion; lift up with strength thy voice, thou who bringest good tidings to Jerusalem; lift it up, be not afraid; say unto the cities of Judah, Behold, (here is) your God!

10 Behold, the Lord Eternal will come with might,^a and his arm ruleth for him: behold, his reward is with him, and his recompense^b before him.

11 Like a shepherd will he feed his flock: with his arm will he gather the lambs, and in his bosom will he carry them, will he lead gently those that suckle their young.

12 ¶ Who hath measured in the hollow of his hand^c the waters, and meted out the heavens with the span, and comprised in a measure^d the dust of the earth, and weighed in the scale-beam the mountains, and the hills in balances?

13 Who hath meted out^e the Spirit of the LORD? and (who was) his counsellor that he could have given him information?

14 With whom took he counsel, that he gave him understanding, and taught him the path of justice, and taught him knowledge, and caused him to know the way of understanding?

15 Behold, nations are as a drop out of a bucket, and as the small dust of the balance

are they accounted: behold, isles are like the flying dust.^f

16 And Lebanon is not sufficient for burning, and its beasts do not suffice for burnt-offering.

17 ¶ All the nations are as naught before him; less than nothing, and vanity^g are they accounted to him.

18 To whom then will ye liken God? or what likeness will ye compare unto him?

19 The graven image—this the artificer hath cast, and the goldsmith hath overspread it with gold, and fabricated (on it) silver chains.

20 He that is skilled in the choice^h chooseth a wood that will not rot; he seeketh unto himself a skilful workman to prepare a graven image, that shall not be moved.

21 Know ye not? hear ye not? hath it not been told you from the beginning?ⁱ have ye not paid attention to the foundations of the earth?

22 (It is he) that dwelleth above the circle of the earth, while its inhabitants are as grasshoppers; that stretched out the heavens as a curtain, and spreadeth them out as a tent to dwell in;

23 That bringeth princes to naught; rendering the judges of the earth as vanity.

24 Yea, they were not yet planted; yea, they were not yet sown; yea, their stem had not yet taken root in the earth: when he but breathed upon them, and they withered, and the storm-wind carrieth them away as stubble.

25 To whom then will ye liken me, that I should be equal to? saith the Holy One.

26 Lift up your eyes on high, and see who hath created these? he that bringeth out their host by number; that calleth them all by name; from him, who is great in might, and strong in power, not one escapeth.^j

27 ¶ Why wilt say thou, O Jacob, and

^a Heinemann, "as the mighty one."

^b Rashi. Jonathan, "behold, the reward of those who have done his word is with him; for all their deeds are known before him."

^c Rashi, "with his steps."

^d שיש, literally, "a third;" hence Rashi, "a third desert, a third habitable land, a third seas and rivers."

^e Rashi, after the Massorah, "Who has meted out the spirit? the Lord."

^f Jonathan. Redak, "behold, isles he lifteth up like fine dust."

^g Sachs and others, "nonentities;" properly, "the formless, chaotic state;" but it is impossible to find a simple English word nearer than "vanity."

^h Rashi, and it is then a continuation of the description of how idols are made. Others, "who is poorer in his gifts;" i. e. who cannot have an idol cast, but one carved of wood.

ⁱ Lit. "is missed;" it means that, numerous as are the stars, they all are always there to do God's bidding. The prophet contrasts the idols with God; those are the works of human hands, while He is the maker of all.